

## Minimising total treatment time

- Using the given code, one finds

$$f(\infty) = \sum_{k=3}^{\infty} (1/2)^k + (\text{tiny corrections}) = 1/4,$$

since  $1/2 + 1/4 + 1/8 + \dots = 1$  <sup>1</sup>. Thus  $a_2 = 2f(\infty) + \frac{1}{2} = 2 \cdot \frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{2} = 1$  (up to negligible terms).

- Hence  $a_1 = 1 \geq a_2 \approx 1$ , so the fastest infusion is therapy 1. By linear programming (a linear objective on the line segment) the minimum is at an endpoint <sup>2</sup>. Concretely, the minimum time is achieved at  $(x_1, x_2) = (1, 0)$  (giving total dose 1).
- The infinity-norm distance from  $(0.1, 0.9)$  to  $(1, 0)$  is  $\max(|0.1 - 1|, |0.9 - 0|) = 0.9$ , which is much larger than  $0.15$ . Therefore  $(0.1, 0.9)$  is **not** within  $0.15$  of the minimiser.

**Answer:** No,  $(0.1, 0.9)$  lies  $0.9$  away (in  $\|\cdot\|_{\infty}$ ) from the optimal point (approximately  $(1, 0)$ ), so it is not within  $0.15$  of a minimiser <sup>1</sup> <sup>2</sup>.

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<sup>1</sup> Geometric series - Wikipedia

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Geometric\\_series](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Geometric_series)

<sup>2</sup> linear programming - Simplex Algorithm: Why must the optimal value of the LP lie on the face or vertex of a polyhedron? - Computer Science Stack Exchange

<https://cs.stackexchange.com/questions/84343/simplex-algorithm-why-must-the-optimal-value-of-the-lp-lie-on-the-face-or-vertex>